



FREE GUIDE · 01

Mouth & Nasal Breathing

Why how we breathe shapes health – and how to retrain it.

Why nasal breathing matters

Your nose is built to prepare every breath. Breathing through it filters dust and allergens, warms and humidifies the air, and releases nitric oxide that helps your lungs absorb oxygen. Nasal breathing also encourages the lips to seal and the tongue to rest gently on the roof of the mouth – the natural posture that supports healthy jaw and airway development.

COMMON SIGNS OF MOUTH BREATHING

- Lips apart or mouth open at rest, awake or asleep
- Dry, cracked lips and frequent thirst at night
- Snoring, noisy breathing, or restless sleep
- Daytime tiredness, brain fog, or irritability
- Frequent congestion, throat clearing, or dark under-eye circles

TIP

Try this: the lip-seal check

Several times a day, notice where your lips and tongue are. Aim for lips lightly together, teeth slightly apart, and the tongue resting on the roof of the mouth – breathing slowly in and out through the nose.

SIMPLE HABITS TO BUILD

- Practice gentle, quiet nasal breathing during calm activities
- Keep the nose clear with saline rinses when congested
- Notice and reset an open-mouth posture throughout the day
- Stay hydrated to support healthy nasal and oral tissues

When to seek support

If mouth breathing persists despite a clear nose — or comes with snoring, poor sleep, or daytime fatigue — a myofunctional therapy assessment can identify the cause and a personalized plan. Persistent nasal blockage is also worth discussing with your physician or an ENT.

This guide is for general education only and is not a substitute for individualized medical or dental advice, diagnosis, or treatment. For a personalized assessment, please reach out to Myo Family Health.

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